

IT IS TIME FOR JESUS

TEXT: Ephesians 1:7-12 (NKJV) *“In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of His grace ⁸ which He made to abound toward us in all wisdom and prudence, ⁹ having made known to us the mystery of His will, according to His good pleasure which He purposed in Himself, ¹⁰ that in the dispensation of the fullness of the times He might gather together in one all things in Christ, both which are in heaven and which are on earth—in Him. ¹¹ In Him also we have obtained an inheritance, being predestined according to the purpose of Him who works all things according to the counsel of His will, ¹² that we who first trusted in Christ should be to the praise of His glory.”*

Galatians 4:4-5 (NKJV) *“But when the fullness of the time had come, God sent forth His Son, born of a woman, born under the law, ⁵ to*

redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption as sons.”

INTRO: In the opening remarks of his letter to the Ephesians, Paul feels it important to let them know right up front what it means to be ***“in Christ”***. In doing so, he not only addressed what they could expect if they continued ***“in Christ”***, but what those of us who would come along at a later time could expect, if we continue, ***“in Christ”***.

Then he say’s something very curious in Vs. 10. ***“In the dispensation of the fullness of the times He might gather together in one all things in Christ, both which are in heaven and which are on earth—in Him.*”** The word ***“fullness”*** is the word ***“Plhrwma”*** (Pla-ro-mah) which means to complete or to fill up. In other words, there will be a point, when time has filled up, that certain things will happen on earth as well as in heaven. (That is a completely different sermon)

In his letter to the Galatians, with regard to the first coming of Christ, Paul writes “***But when the fullness of the time had come, God sent forth His Son, born of a woman, born under the law,*** ⁵ ***to redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption as sons.***” The word “*fullness*” as it is used here is the same word, “*Plhrwma*” (Pla-ro-mah) meaning to complete or to fill up. In other words, “***When the appointed time had fully filled up...***”

- When the time came...
- When the time was right...
- At the appointed time...
- At precisely the right time...

Listen to what Paul said would occur when time had filled completely up. “***God sent forth His Son, born of a woman, born under the law, to redeem THOSE WHO WERE UNDER THE LAW, that WE might receive the adoption as sons.***” When the time for Jesus’ first coming had fully arrived, His coming affected everyone

who was alive then and there, those who have lived since, and those of us who are alive now!

It is time for Jesus!

**THE FIRST COMING OF JESUS
REMINDS US THAT THERE IS A TIME
AND PLACE FOR EVERYTHING**

Ecclesiastes 3:1 (NKJV) *“To everything there is a season, A time for every purpose under heaven...”*

- Born – Die...
- Plant – Harvest...
- Kill – Heal...
- Break down – Build up...
- Weep – Laugh...
- Mourn – Dance...
- Lose – Gain...
- Love – Hate...
- War – Peace...
- Etc...

While there is a time for all things, there are certain things that cannot happen until “*Time has filled up.*”

It is time for Jesus!

THE FIRST COMING OF JESUS DID NOT OCCUR UNTIL THE TIME WAS FULLY COME – THE TIME WAS EXACTLY RIGHT

Galatians made this abundantly clear: “*When the fullness of the time had come, God sent forth His Son, born of a woman, born under the law, ⁵ to redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption as sons.*”

Listen to what was said of Simeon, the uncle of Jesus: Luke 2:25-32 (KJV) “*There was a man in Jerusalem whose name was Simeon, and this man was just and devout, waiting for the Consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was upon him. ²⁶ And it had been revealed to him*

by the Holy Spirit that he would not see death before he had seen the Lord's Christ. ²⁷ So he came by the Spirit into the temple. And when the parents brought in the Child Jesus, to do for Him according to the custom of the law, ²⁸ he took Him up in his arms and blessed God and said: ²⁹ "Lord, now You are letting Your servant depart in peace, According to Your word; ³⁰ For my eyes have seen Your salvation ³¹ Which You have prepared before the face of all peoples, ³² A light to bring revelation to the Gentiles, and the glory of Your people Israel."

Look at what was said of Joseph of Arimathea. Luke 23:50-51 (NKJV) *"There was a man named Joseph, a council member, a good and just man. ⁵¹ He had not consented to their decision and deed. He was from Arimathea, a city of the Jews, who himself was also waiting for the kingdom of God."*

Simeon and Joseph were waiting for Jesus, and when time filled up, they saw Him with their very own eyes! I am looking for Jesus; you are

looking for Jesus; and when time fills up, we are going to see him!

It is time for Jesus!

THE SECOND COMING OF JESUS WILL NOT OCCUR UNTIL THE TIME HAS FULLY COME

Because of the world's situation, the question on the lips of everyone is: "*When will Jesus return?*" "*When will the end of the world come?*" Listen to the words of Jesus - Matthew 24:32-36 (NKJV) "*Learn this parable from the fig tree: When its branch has already become tender and puts forth leaves, you know that summer is near.*" ³³ *So you also, when you see all these things, know that it is near—at the doors!* ³⁴ *Assuredly, I say to you, this generation will by no means pass away till all these things take place.* ³⁵ *Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will by no means pass away.* ³⁶ *"But of that day and hour no one*

knows, not even the angels of heaven, but My Father only.”

We cannot predict the day nor hour of the second coming of Jesus. We cannot predict the year. But we can know the season based on what the Scripture say's will be happening just prior to His coming!

- Like the days of Noah...
- The fig tree buds... 1948
- This generation shall not pass away... Those born in 1948 are currently 72 – Plus 7 years tribulation = 79

Time is filling up!

It is time for Jesus.

1 Thessalonians 4

1 Corinthians 15